MANUAL QA · WHOLE APP · UPDATED OCTOBER 2026

App QA Walkthrough

One run through the whole app, from inviting a teammate to closing a project. It covers everything since the September walkthrough: guided tours, help on every section, safer invites, the October audit fixes, time logging, and sprint velocity. Follow the parts in order, since each one sets up the next.

• TEAM & SETTINGS • ESTIMATOR • ZOHO CRM • PBS BILLING • PROJECTS & BOARD • WORKLOAD & REPORTS

WHAT CHANGED SINCE THE LAST WALKTHROUGH

- **Tours and help.** Every page has a guided tour (the **?** in the top bar), newcomers get a welcome and a Getting started checklist, and every section has its own **?** that explains it in plain words.
- **Safer invites.** The emailed link opens a page with a **Continue** button, so email scanners can't use it up. Admins can also hand out a password setup link from the Team page.
- **Projects come from estimates. New project** is switched off, the New estimate dialog no longer picks a project, and an approved estimate is frozen: editing the project's tasks no longer changes the quote.
- **Every project gets a PO.** There is no separate Create PO button any more: Start project raises the PO as its last step, and only once the estimate's Zoho deal is won.
- **Time logging.** A task's logged total can't be typed over any more. Time is added with **Add time** or the timer, and deleting a task keeps the hours people logged.
- **Velocity and burndown.** Each project page shows how many hours each sprint finished, the average pace, a finish forecast and a burndown. Reports has a Velocity column.
- **Fixes.** Due dates save on the day you pick, sign-out clears the screen, completed projects leave everyone's workload, and on-time delivery uses the day a task was actually finished.

BEFORE YOU START

- Have four logins ready: an **admin**, a **manager**, a **member** and a **viewer**. Part 1 also needs a mailbox you can open for a new test invitee.
- Use a **test client** in Zoho. Part 3 writes to the real CRM, and step 11 writes to real billing, which has no delete.
- Name everything you create **MY TEST ....** On **real** projects and estimates, only look. If a dialog offers to change one, press **Cancel**.
- Keep a phone, or a browser window narrowed to about 375px, for the checks at the end.

Part 1 — Invite a teammate

About ten minutes, as the **admin**. This creates the newcomer you'll use in Part 2.

01 Send an invite • TEAM CHANGED

Team → **Invite**. Use the test mailbox, role **Member**.

> EXPECT The invite email arrives within a couple of minutes (check spam the first time). A dialog also shows a backup **password setup link** with **Copy link**, so you can send it by chat if the email is slow.

02 Accept it as the newcomer • TEAM NEW

In a private window, open the link from the email.

> EXPECT A page asks you to press **Continue**. Nothing happens until you press it. Then you choose a password and land on the Dashboard, never on the home page.
>
> Open the same email link again: it says the link has already been used or has expired, and how to get a new one.

03 The setup-link key button • TEAM NEW

Back as the admin, Team → the **key** button on a pending invite's row. Then try the same button on someone who already has a password.

> EXPECT A pending invitee gets a fresh setup link to copy. Someone who already set a password is refused, because that link would sign its holder in as them.

Part 2 — Finding your way

About ten minutes, signed in as the **new member** from Part 1.

04 Welcome and the first tour • DASHBOARD NEW

The Dashboard opens with **Welcome to Timeline Estimator**. Press **Start the tour** and step through it. While a step is highlighted, try clicking the highlighted button.

> EXPECT Each step points at a real control and explains it. Clicking the highlighted control does nothing, because tours only explain. Reload: the welcome doesn't come back.

05 Getting started checklist • DASHBOARD NEW

Dashboard → Mine → the **Getting started** card. Press **Show me** on one item, then do what it asks (for example, upload an avatar in Settings).

> EXPECT **Show me** opens the right page and starts its tour at that step. Back on the Dashboard, the item you completed is ticked on its own. Items that don't apply yet ("Nothing assigned to you yet") never stop you reaching 100%.

06 Help on every section • ALL PAGES NEW

On each page, click the **?** at the top right of the page header and of each section. Then open the top-bar **?** → **Tour: …** for that page.

> EXPECT Every **?** opens a short plain-English explanation on click, phone included. Bold words have normal spaces around them (no "work?It isn't"). Member tours never mention buttons a member doesn't have.

Part 3 — From estimate to project

About thirty minutes, as the **admin**. The pricing run itself is unchanged from v2; these steps check what's new around it.

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07 Create the estimate • ESTIMATOR CHANGED

Estimator → **New estimate**. Title it **MY TEST – walkthrough**, then pick the client with **Find in Zoho** (a test company). Add three or four catalog tasks.

> EXPECT
>
> Platform starts on **WordPress**. The client can't be typed, and **Create and open** stays disabled until one is picked from Zoho.
>
> The dialog has **no project picker**. In the editor's Setup tab, **Internal project** reads "None yet — Start project creates it" and can't be changed.

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08 Generate line items asks first • ESTIMATOR NEW

Scope & risk → **Start guided scoping**. Hover the **(i)** beside a few questions, then tap one on a phone. Answer a few questions, then **Generate line items**. Press **Cancel** on the dialog that appears.

> EXPECT
>
> A section the job doesn't include (e.g. **SEO & Digital Marketing**) can be unticked with **Include this section in the estimate**: it shows "Left out", its questions and hours disappear, and ticking it again brings your answers back. Sections 1 and 2 can't be switched off.
>
> Required questions carry an amber **Required** label and highlight until answered (then a green ✓), each section says how many are left, and on a phone the section circles show the count.
>
> Every question has an (i) with a plain-English explanation. It opens on hover with a mouse and on tap on a phone; a second tap closes it.
>
> Because the estimate already has lines, a **Replace all line items?** dialog asks first. Cancel leaves your catalog lines exactly as they were.

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09 Set the details that carry over • ESTIMATOR

Adjust tab → set the **risk buffer** to `20%` and tick **Requirements not pinned down**. In **Who does the work**, switch between **Best-fit** and **Fastest** and watch the launch date; leave it on the one you want. Note the timeline's launch date and one line's quoted hours.

> EXPECT The buffer moves only dates, and the box prices every line as Advanced. All three tabs say so.
>
> Best-fit / Fastest changes the launch date but never the price. "See who does what" lists each task with a person. Once the estimate is approved (step 11) the choice locks and the card shows the quoted launch date.

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10 No PO before the deal is won • ESTIMATOR • PBS CHANGED

Set the estimate's status to **Approved** by hand, without sending it to Zoho. Look for **Start project**. Then set it back to Draft.

> EXPECT No Start project button. In its place: "Start project needs a won Zoho deal — every project gets a PO."

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11 Send, win, raise the PO • ZOHO • PBS

Review → **Send to Zoho**. Then Estimator → **Stages** and move the card to **Closed Won**.

> EXPECT On Closed Won the status flips to **Approved** on its own, and **Start project** appears, on the card and in the estimate's header. There is no separate Create PO button.
>
> **On a computer:** press on an empty part of the board (or a card's body, not its buttons) and drag sideways. The board slides like Trello. Letting go doesn't open or move anything. The same works on a sprint's task board.

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12 Start the project • ESTIMATOR • PROJECTS CHANGED

Assign the teammate from Part 1 a work key so they get a task. Then **Start project** (it should say "Plan: ... as quoted", with no Best-fit/Fastest buttons) → **Review schedule** → **Next: billing**. Press **Back** once and come forward again. Then **Create PO & start project**.

> EXPECT The billing step's PO dates match the schedule you just reviewed. Back returns to the schedule. The PO is raised first, then the project opens, and the estimate shows the PO number.
>
> The sprint dates match the estimate's timeline from step 9, buffer included. The project's own risk buffer reads **0%**, because the estimate's buffer is already in those dates.
>
> Each task's estimate equals its line's **quoted** hours (Advanced, from step 9), not the base hours.
>
> Your teammate gets **one** notification, "... assigned you N tasks on "MY TEST ..." — accept or decline", not one per task.

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13 The approved estimate is frozen • PROJECTS • ESTIMATOR NEW

On the new project, open a task and change its estimated hours. Then open the estimate.

> EXPECT One message says the estimate is approved and keeps the agreed price. The estimate's line and total are unchanged.

Part 4 — Working the board

About fifteen minutes, as the **teammate** (member), on the MY TEST project.

14 Accept the work • BOARD

Click the notification from step 12. Open one of your tasks and press **Accept**.

> EXPECT The notification shows a real time ("just now"). Before you accept, the drawer has no **Add time** field. After you accept, it does.

15 Due dates land on the day you pick • BOARD FIXED

Set a task's due date to the 15th of next month in the drawer. Check the card, then switch to **List** and **Table**.

> EXPECT Every view shows the 15th, not the 14th or the 16th. (If you can, repeat with your computer's time zone set ahead of and behind UTC.)

16 Log time • BOARD CHANGED

In the drawer's Time tracking box, type `1.5` in **Add time** and press it. Then run the session timer for a minute and press **Stop**.

> EXPECT **Logged total** can't be edited by anyone, admins included. It grows by 1.5, then by the timer session. Workload → Mine → "Logged this week" grows by the same amounts.

17 Finish a task • BOARD

Drag the task from step 15 by its grip handle to **Done**. Move a few other cards between columns too.

> EXPECT Cards move instantly and stay put after a reload, with no error page. The finished task leaves your Workload.

Part 5 — Tracking

About fifteen minutes, as the **manager**.

18 Velocity and burndown • PROJECT PAGE NEW

Open the MY TEST project and scroll below the **Timeline** to the **Velocity** card. Then edit the sprint holding the task you finished in step 17 so it **ended yesterday** (move its start date back too if needed), and look again.

> EXPECT At first, Velocity and Forecast read "—" with "Shows once a sprint has ended", never 0. The burndown shows the sprint running today, and its line stops at today.
>
> Once the sprint has ended yesterday, Velocity reads **0 h / sprint** and Forecast says it needs a velocity first. That's correct: the task was finished **today**, after the sprint ended, and late work doesn't count for a sprint. The bar chart shows a Planned bar with no Finished bar.
>
> Put the sprint's dates back. To see a real number, check a project with sprints that ended after work was finished in them.

19 The same numbers everywhere • WORKLOAD • REPORTS

Compare your teammate on Workload → Team, Dashboard → Team, and Reports. Check Reports' **Velocity** column for MY TEST.

> EXPECT Utilisation, overdue and pending counts agree on all three pages. Reports' Velocity matches the project page.

20 On-time uses the finish date • REPORTS FIXED

Note the on-time delivery percentage on the Dashboard and in Reports. Rename the task you finished in step 17.

> EXPECT The percentage doesn't change. A later edit no longer counts as the moment the task was finished.

21 Finished projects leave the workload • WORKLOAD NEW

As the admin, set the MY TEST project's status to **Completed**. Check Workload, both Dashboard views and Reports' Overdue.

> EXPECT The project's leftover open tasks no longer count toward anyone's load or the overdue figures. Set it back to Active afterwards.

Then try to break it

These are the guards. Each one should stop you and say why.

Projects page → New project	→ The button is greyed out. Hovering explains that projects start from an approved estimate. No "New project" in the top bar or the + menu
Press Start project in two tabs on the same approved estimate	→ The second says "This estimate already has a project". Only one project exists
Open a task you haven't accepted, as a member	→ No Add time field. Logged total is read-only for everyone
Delete a task that has logged time (as a manager)	→ The dialog says the hours stay on each person's record. Afterwards, Workload's "Logged this week" is unchanged
Delete a project (admin): read the dialog, then Cancel	→ It names the sprint and task counts, the logged hours that stay, the linked estimate and its PO
Review tab on an estimate with no Zoho client (an old one with a typed name)	→ Send to Zoho is off, and an amber note says why, with a Go to Setup button. Setup marks the client "Typed by hand, not linked to Zoho"
Settings → Workspace → Holidays: mark Columbus Day as Working (admin), check Calendar and Workload for that week, then set it back	→ It stops being a day off everywhere — no holiday on the calendar, full capacity that week — and returns when set back. Managers see the list read-only
Approved estimate with no Zoho deal	→ No Start project; says it needs a won deal
Edit a task's hours on an approved estimate's project	→ The estimate's price doesn't move
Generate line items on an estimate that already has lines	→ "Replace all line items?" asks first. Cancel changes nothing
Sign out, then press the browser's Back button	→ You stay on the sign-in page. Nobody's dashboard flashes up
Open an invite link a second time	→ It explains the link was used or expired, and how to get a new one

Change `next=` in an invite link to `//example.com`	→ After Continue you land on the Dashboard, never on another site
Deactivate a member who is signed in elsewhere	→ Their next change fails straight away, not an hour later
Open a real estimate or project	→ Look only. Press Cancel on any dialog that offers to change it

Also check

Quick passes once the run above is clean.

Top bar on a phone (375px)	→ Four controls: ☰, ?, 🔔, +. The page name isn't cut off
Estimator tabs on a phone	→ One row of five tabs ("Scope", "Lines" are short names). Nothing scrolls off the edge
Section ? buttons on a phone	→ No empty strip down the right side of headers and cards
A tour on a phone	→ The popover docks at the top or bottom, away from what it highlights, and its buttons work
Velocity card on a phone	→ Sprint names under the bars don't overlap (some are skipped; tap a bar for its name)
Any page at 375px, 768px and desktop	→ No sideways page scroll. The Gantt and wide tables scroll inside their own boxes
Sign in as a viewer	→ No action buttons anywhere, no Estimator, no rates
Notifications and activity	→ New entries show "just now", never an odd past date

CLEAN UP WHEN YOU'RE DONE

- Set MY TEST back to Active if you left it Completed, then delete the MY TEST project and estimate (admin). Time you logged stays on your record, which is expected.
- Team → deactivate, then delete, the test invitee. Remove any work key you added.
- The Zoho deal and the PBS purchase order stay behind and need tidying by hand in those systems.

Found something? Note the step number, what you expected and what you saw, with a screenshot. If the page shows "This page couldn't load", open **Error details** on it (on a test copy) and include that too. Anything touching Zoho or PBS is a real write, so flag it rather than retrying.